

E-mail #1: "Prospecting"

In the coming weeks you will be receiving a series of e-mails from me to help kick off your "Badge Run". For Veteran's and Rookie's alike, the goal should be to increase your sales to badge and to earn one of the many award levels that will be discussed at the meeting next week.

One of the questions we are often asked is "Where do I start?"

The answer is that all sales begin with **PROSPECTING**.

However, there is a right way and a wrong way to prospect. The wrong way is to ask yourself, "Who do I know who will buy an ad?" This question limits your creativity by causing you to attempt to answer an unanswerable question. There is simply no way you will know "who will buy and ad" until you ask them...

Therefore, the right way to begin prospecting for potential ad buyers is to ask yourself the following questions (as you do, write down the names that pop into your mind without attempting to qualify the prospect in any way):

Who would I call if I:

- Had a plumbing problem?
- Had an electrical problem?
- Needed a fence?
- Needed pool maintenance?
- Needed landscaping?
- Needed a haircut or styling?
- Needed specialty groceries?
- Wanted to go out to dinner?
- Wanted to buy a car or truck?
- Needed to get my car or truck fixed?
- Needed my suits tailored?
- Wanted to get my jeans washed, starched and pressed?
- Wanted (or needed) a glass of wine, a bottle of wine, a quick beer, etc.?
- Wanted to try to get a friend a job?
- Needed to buy a suit, a dress, or other apparel?
- Needed office supplies?
- Wanted to wash my car or get my car washed?
- Needed supplies to hunt, fish, golf or whatever turns you on (thank you Marvin Zindler)?
- Needed Tack?
- Wanted to add on to your home?
- Needed a new couch, bed, dining room, etc?

Who do I know that owns a company?

Who do I know that attends the Houston Live Stock Show and Rodeo at least annually?

Who do I know that used to be on a committee of the HLSR?

Which of my family members has expressed an interest in supporting HLSR in some way?

Who, among my friends, has expressed an interest in supporting HLSR in some way?

Please take a couple of minutes to review these questions a couple of times and just write down the names.... Hopefully you will have a list of 20 or 30 names. These people are known as "Suspects" in the jargon of sales.

In my next letter I will try to help you convert the "Suspects" into "Prospects".